

Data Preboarding Engagements

Representative Project Sketch

This project sketch is guidance for independent consultants. It is based on four recent preboarding projects in FinTech, Logistics, Pharma, and Information Services companies in the US. Its purpose is to set directional expectations. It does not define specific solutions engagements.

Solution Customer

Acme Inc. is a medium-sized company with fewer than 500 employees. It supports customers with an invoicing management service that connect large buyers with regional distributors.

High-level Goals

- Increase the robustness of file feed data management
- Automate, increase consistency, add monitoring
- Reduce manual quality checking

Why Now?

- Files have been lost, and/or
- Bad data has caused problems for customers and/or
- Knowledge loss due to staff turnover and/or
- Systems modernization and increased scalability

Systems and Processes

Acme works with 300 distributors and seven large retailers. The distributors send Acme invoices monthly or more frequently. Most invoices data files arrive in CSV. Some are Excel or EDI, which is mapped to CSV by an EDI consultant. Invoices must be processed within 45 days. The data is frequently messy or incorrect, requiring multiple round trips before being aggregated and forwarded to the retailer. Data must be versioned and retained for various time spans, depending on distributor requirements. A team of eight BizOps specialists review incoming files and iterate with distributors to make the data correct. An IT team of two handle data management scripts. A DBA helps organize the data and store it.

Technologies

- Windows Server
- S3 for the data lake
- SQL Server for the data warehouse
- SSIS for database loading
- Python for data management scripts
- SFTP, S3, and email to receive data
- Coviant Diplomat MFT as the SFTP, S3, and Gmail transfer management server
- Grafana for monitoring and alerting
- FlightPath Server for preboarding and archiving

Project Sponsor

Senior manager –or– Director of Technology or Product

Project Team

1 lead technical staff. 2 to 3 contributing technical specialists; e.g. a DBA or data mapping lead. 1 or 2 business operations team members.

Timeframe

Depending on scope, first working delivery in 2 weeks. First production use in the 4 to 6 week range.

FlightPath Server will be used for data preboarding. It will connect the MFT server to the file loading process, perform data validation and upgrading, connect file-feed operations to Grafana, and serve as the permanent file and metadata archive using its S3 backend.